

NARENDRANATH PANDA

Senior Platform Engineer | SRE | DevOps | Kubernetes/EKS | AWS | IaC | Observability

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Senior Platform Engineer and SRE Architect with 19+ years of experience in software, systems, and infrastructure, including **12+ years** specializing in SRE, DevOps, and platform engineering. Strong hands-on expertise in Kubernetes, Amazon EKS, AWS Cloud, and Infrastructure as Code (Terraform, Terragrunt, Helm, GitOps) with a deep focus on observability, telemetry, and high availability. Proven track record designing and operating large-scale, multi-tenant Kubernetes platforms across on-prem data centres, AWS, and edge environments. Experienced in building CI/CD platforms, driving SLO/SLI-based reliability programs, leading cross-functional DevOps teams, and implementing FinOps and AIOps initiatives.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Platform Architecture & Design: AWS | Amazon EKS | Kubernetes | Docker | Linux | Harbor | Vault | Ceph | Rook.
Infrastructure as Code and Automation: Terraform | Terragrunt | OpenTofu | Helm | Kustomize | Ansible | GitOps | ArgoCD | GitLab CI | GitHub Actions | Jenkins | AWS infrastructure automation | multi-account AWS governance.
DevOps | SRE | and Platform Engineering: CI/CD pipelines | release management | environment management | blue/green and canary deployments | GitOps workflows | SLO/SLI design | incident management | on-call rotations | root cause analysis | reliability engineering | environment orchestration | DevOps Center of Excellence
Observability, Monitoring and Telemetry: Prometheus | Grafana | Loki | OpenTelemetry | VictoriaMetrics | DataDog | ELK / OpenSearch stack | Thanos | distributed tracing | logging and metrics pipelines | alerting and dashboards | golden signals | MTTR reduction | operational intelligence
Data and Messaging: Apache Kafka | PostgreSQL | ETL pipelines | FluentD | OpenSearch | high-throughput streaming | data quality and reliability
Security, Compliance, and FinOps: DevSecOps | IAM | least privilege | admission controllers | Kyverno (concept-level) | mTLS (concepts) | security best practices | FOSS compliance automation | FinOps | cost optimization | multi-account AWS cost governance
Leadership and Ways of Working: Team leadership | technical mentorship | cross-functional stakeholder management | Agile/Scrum | global collaboration | influencing architecture decisions | driving standards and best practices
AI / AIOps and Emerging Technologies: AI agent design | Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) | Large Language Models | Model Context Protocol (MCP) | vector databases (Pinecone, Chroma) | AIOps automation | AI-enabled DevOps workflows
TOOLS: GitLab | GitHub | Jira | Confluence | MS Teams | Slack | SonarQube

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Nokia Pvt. Ltd.

R&D Architect | July 2013 – Present | Bengaluru, India

Platform Modernization and Kubernetes Scale:

- Architected and operated a global Kubernetes platform spanning 15+ data centre clusters (on-prem and AWS EKS) and 1000+ customer edge Kubernetes clusters, ensuring high availability and zero-downtime operations across 5 global locations.
- Led platform modernization and cloud-readiness initiatives for 8–9 key products, including containerization strategies, migration from legacy platforms, and adoption of cloud-native architectures on AWS and Kubernetes.

Infrastructure as Code and AWS:

- Designed and implemented a production-grade “Registry-as-a-Service” solution using Terraform and Terragrunt, automating Harbor registry lifecycle, project provisioning, robot account management, retention policies, and cross-registry replication at enterprise scale.
- Provisioned AWS EKS Auto Mode clusters using Terragrunt and OpenTofu, including automated VPC, subnets, security groups, S3, and EC2 worker node lifecycle, cost-optimized scaling, and GitOps-ready bootstrap with zero-downtime upgrades.
- Built self-service GitLab CI/CD pipelines with integrated terraform plan/apply workflows, enabling teams to provision compliant infrastructure on-demand while enforcing security, compliance, and governance.

DevOps, CI/CD, and GitOps:

- Architected and implemented standardized CI/CD workflows using GitLab CI, Helm, Kustomize, and ArgoCD-based GitOps across multiple products, reducing deployment cycles by 50 percent and achieving 99.95 percent platform availability.
- Implemented environment management standards and configuration-as-code practices to improve deployment reliability and accelerate feature delivery.

Observability, Telemetry, and SRE:

- Designed and deployed telemetry pipelines for 1000+ edge Kubernetes clusters using Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, OpenTelemetry, VictoriaMetrics, and OpenSearch / Elasticsearch to provide unified metrics, logs, and traces.
- Established SLO/SLI frameworks and golden signals for mission-critical platform services, maintaining 99.95 percent availability and improving incident detection and response.

- Created alerting and dashboard standards for infrastructure and application teams, enabling proactive incident detection and shortening MTTR.

Incident Management and On-Call:

- Led 24/7 global on-call rotation for DevOps and platform services, including incident triage, coordination of multi-team responses, deep root cause analysis, and implementation of preventive measures.
- Facilitated war-room-style debugging sessions to resolve high-severity production incidents and persistent reliability issues, driving permanent fixes and automation.

Team Leadership and DevOps Enablement:

- Directed a 15-engineer DevOps and platform team, instilling best practices in IaC, CI/CD, observability, and SRE principles.
- Mentored engineers and product teams through targeted training sessions on cloud-native architecture, environment management, deployment strategies, and reliability engineering, driving consistent adoption of modern platform practices.

Cost Optimization and FinOps:

- Launched and led a FinOps program for cloud infrastructure, reducing spend by approximately 15 percent year-over-year and avoiding an estimated 500K USD overspend through cost visibility, rightsizing, and policy-based automation.
- Implemented AWS scaling strategies and automation using Python and Terraform to optimize resource utilization, including compute, storage, and networking.

Security, Compliance, and Governance:

- Automated compliance pipelines for 300+ FOSS components to support secure and compliant software releases, reducing manual effort and risk.
- Embedded security controls and best practices across Kubernetes, CI/CD, and infrastructure automation, including image management, least privilege access, and secure configuration baselines.

Data Engineering and Streaming:

- Built ETL pipelines for PostgreSQL-backed internal systems, improving reliability and observability of data flows.
- Managed Apache Kafka clusters for high throughput streaming workloads, supporting multiple teams with real-time data processing, and integrating metrics and logs into the ELK / OpenSearch stack.

AI, AIOps, and Innovation:

- Developed a proof-of-concept AI-driven Git triage agent using RAG and Llama3 to automate categorization of more than 10,000 issues, projecting a 40–50 percent reduction in manual triage effort and enabling one-click issue creation workflows.

Misys

Senior Developer | April 2011 – July 2013 | Bengaluru, India

- Co-engineered a Java-based framework for the **LoanIQ** product, replacing a legacy Smalltalk implementation and improving performance by approximately 50 percent for key banking clients.
- Served as Scrum Master for a development team, improving bug triage, release cadence, and development workflows, leading to ~70 percent faster defect resolution.

Logica CMG

IT Consultant | July 2006 – March 2011 | India

- Developed Java-based applications for clients in education, oil and gas, and banking and finance, including university admission systems and financial services platforms.
- Delivered maintainable and scalable Java solutions following best practices, coding standards, and performance guidelines.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATION

- **Master of Technology (MTech) – WILP**
Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani | 2015 – 2017
- **Bachelor of Engineering – Information Technology**
Utkal University | 2000 – 2004
- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)**
CNCF | November 2020

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

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| <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Nokia Excellency Award – Delivering Software with Quality (2024)• Exceptional Achievement – Thanks for your Contribution and Mentorship (2025)• Strategic Impact – Successful NDAC DC Migration (2025)• Collaborative Excellence – Excellence in Collaboration for MX Grid (2025) | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Security Leadership – Security Supporter for SRE Systems (2023)• Operational Excellence – Exceptional Work for China Setup Data Centre (2023)• Logica Diamond Award – (2010)• Recognition – Exceptional Work Setting Up Data Centre in 2 Months |
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